

Ravens Empire: The Rise and Fall of Canbera

Long before peace came to the continent of Canbera, the land was divided into sixteen rival kingdoms. Each kingdom fought for wealth, land, and power. Wars never ended. Villages burned every season, kings betrayed one another, and mercenaries grew rich from endless bloodshed.

Among those mercenaries was a small group known as **The Black Ravens**.

No one feared them at first.

Only a few hundred warriors dressed in dark armor with raven feathers tied to their shoulders, they wandered from kingdom to kingdom selling their swords. Their leader was a ruthless and brilliant man named **Kael Draven**. He was not born noble, nor rich. He was the son of a blacksmith who had watched his village destroyed during one of Canbera's many wars.

Kael learned one truth early in life:

“Kings create wars. Mercenaries survive them.”

But Kael did not wish to survive forever.

He wanted to rule.

The Sixteen Kingdoms of Canbera

At the time, the continent of Canbera was divided into sixteen kingdoms:

1. Arctavia
2. Velmora
3. Drakenfall
4. Soltheris
5. Norvak
6. Eldoria
7. Bryndale
8. Kareth
9. Valenholt
10. Mystara
11. Thornveil
12. Caldris
13. Ironmere
14. Zephyria
15. Lunareth

16. Vargoss

Each kingdom had its own army, banners, culture, and ambitions. None trusted the others.

Kael Draven saw opportunity in that division.

The Rise of the Black Ravens

The Black Ravens became famous after the **Battle of Red Hollow**, where only five hundred Ravens defeated nearly four thousand soldiers of Kareth by trapping them inside a burning valley.

Kael believed fear was stronger than numbers.

The Ravens began training harder than any army in Canbera. They marched during storms. They fought with wounds that would cripple ordinary soldiers. They obeyed commands without hesitation.

Soon, kingdoms competed to hire them.

Gold flowed endlessly into Kael's hands.

But Kael's greatest victory came not through battle—

—but through marriage.

The First Kingdom

The Kingdom of Velmora was collapsing from civil war. Its king had only one surviving child: **Princess Elira Velmora**.

Kael offered his mercenary army to save the kingdom.

Within a year, the Ravens crushed the rebels and restored order. The people celebrated Kael as a hero, but the aging king saw something terrifying in the mercenary leader's eyes.

Ambition.

Still, the king had no choice.

To secure peace, Princess Elira was married to Kael Draven.

Months later, the old king mysteriously died in his sleep.

Some whispered poison.

Others said the Ravens silenced the servants who knew the truth.

Kael Draven became King of Velmora.

The Black Ravens became the **Ravens Empire**.

And the conquest of Canberra began.

The Conquest of Canberra

The Ravens Empire did not fight like ordinary kingdoms.

They used terror.

Entire towns that resisted were burned. Enemy generals were nailed to fortress gates. Prisoners were forced to march in chains behind Raven armies as warnings to others.

One by one, kingdoms fell.

Drakenfall resisted for three years before its capital was destroyed by siege towers larger than castle walls.

Ironmere's king surrendered after the Ravens executed every captured noble in front of his palace.

Lunareth attempted diplomacy, but Kael demanded complete submission.

There was no alliance.

No compromise.

No mercy.

By the twentieth year of conquest, all sixteen kingdoms belonged to the Ravens Empire.

Kael Draven crowned himself:

Emperor of All Canberra

The Cruelty of the Empire

Under Raven rule, roads expanded, trade flourished, and crime nearly vanished.

But peace came through fear.

The empire depended heavily on slavery.

Conquered people were branded with raven marks burned into their skin. Millions worked in mines, farms, and massive fortress cities. Entire bloodlines were enslaved for rebelling against the empire.

Children of slaves were born as property.

The empire also created the **Shadow Legions**, secret enforcers who hunted rebels and executed anyone suspected of disloyalty.

People disappeared in the night.

Speaking against the emperor became punishable by death.

The Ravens believed compassion created weakness.

Cruelty created order.

And for decades, no one could challenge them.

The Birth of Rebellion

Far in the ruined lands of Thornveil, a young blacksmith's son watched Raven soldiers execute his parents for hiding escaped slaves.

That boy's name was **Victor Martien**.

Victor survived by fleeing into the mountains, where rebels, escaped slaves, and deserters hid from the empire. There he grew into a warrior unlike any before him.

But Victor possessed something even more dangerous than strength.

Hope.

He believed Canbera did not belong to emperors.

It belonged to its people.

At first, the rebellion was small. They attacked supply wagons, freed prisoners, and vanished into forests before Raven armies arrived.

The empire laughed at them.

Until cities began rising against Raven governors.

Then kingdoms once conquered generations ago remembered who they were.

The rebellion spread across all sixteen kingdoms.

Victor Martien became its symbol.

People called him:

The Flame of Canbera

The Great Continental Rebellion

The rebellion lasted twelve brutal years.

The Ravens Empire still possessed the strongest army in history, but it had grown arrogant. Corrupt nobles fought each other for power while common people starved under taxes and slavery.

Victor united former enemies together.

Soldiers from Arctavia fought beside warriors from Drakenfall.
Former slaves marched with old kings.
Even Raven generals defected after witnessing the empire's cruelty.

The final battle came at the imperial capital of **Nevermore**, the black city built by Kael Draven himself.

Over one million soldiers fought outside its walls.

Fire covered the skies.

For seven days and nights, battle shook the continent.

Victor Martien personally led the final charge into the emperor's fortress.

There he faced the last emperor of the Ravens line, **Emperor Lucien Draven**, descendant of Kael Draven.

Lucien believed fear would rule forever.

Victor proved him wrong.

After a long duel within the burning throne hall, Victor defeated the emperor and shattered the Raven Crown before the surviving armies of Canbera.

The Ravens Empire fell that night.

After nearly a century of rule.

The First Great King of Canbera

After the war, the continent stood broken.

Cities were ruined.

Millions were dead.

The people feared new wars would begin again between the kingdoms.

But something unexpected happened.

The leaders of every kingdom gathered together and unanimously chose Victor Martien to rule—not as emperor, but as protector of the continent.

Victor refused absolute power.

Instead, he created the **United Crown of Canbera**, where each kingdom kept its traditions while serving under one peaceful alliance.

Victor Martien was crowned:

The First Great King of the Continent of Canbera

Unlike the Ravens, Victor outlawed slavery forever.

The prisons were emptied.

The branded slaves were freed.

The Shadow Legions were destroyed.

The fortress of Nevermore was turned into a memorial for those lost under Raven rule.

For the first time in generations, children grew up without hearing the sounds of war.

Fields became green again.

Trade returned.

Families reunited.

Peace finally came to Canbera.

And though the Ravens Empire became one of the darkest chapters in history, people never forgot the lesson learned from its fall:

“An empire built on fear may conquer the world...
but freedom will always rise against it.”